

The cardiac output is the volume of blood pumped by the heart each minute.
It is calculated as the product of stroke volume and heart rate.
Normal cardiac output in a resting adult is approximately five liters per minute.
Stroke volume is the amount of blood ejected from the left ventricle per beat.
Heart rate is the number of heartbeats per minute.
Cardiac output increases during exercise to meet the oxygen demand of tissues.
The Frank-Starling law describes the relationship between stroke volume and end-diastolic volume.
Preload refers to the degree of stretch of cardiac muscle fibers at the end of diastole.
Afterload is the pressure that the heart must overcome to eject blood.
Contractility is the intrinsic ability of cardiac muscle to generate force.
Physical therapists monitor cardiac output during rehabilitation of cardiac patients.
Early ambulation after myocardial infarction improves cardiac recovery outcomes.